

Impact of Word Choice - Workbook 1

Focused practice - Workbook 1 of 3

How to use this workbook

Read each short text closely. Answer without checking the key. Then compare your reasoning with the explanation and mark the mistake type if you were wrong.

Before you start

- Underline or mentally mark the exact wording that controls your answer.
- Do not choose an option just because it is true in general; it must fit this text.
- After checking, write one sentence explaining why the strongest wrong answer fails.

Flood Gate

The report says water surged through the opening after the temporary gate failed.

1. Why use surged instead of moved?

- A. To emphasize rapid, forceful movement.
- B. To prove the water was clean.
- C. To show the opening was small.
- D. To make the report humorous.

2. If surged were replaced with flowed, what would change most?

- A. The movement would sound less forceful.
- B. The gate would no longer fail.
- C. The time would change.
- D. The water would become deeper.

Team Debrief

The manager says the delay exposed a weakness in the approval process.

3. What does exposed emphasize?

- A. The delay made a hidden problem visible.
- B. The process was outdoors.
- C. The delay caused sunlight.
- D. The manager ended the process.

4. Why is showed less forceful?

- A. It lacks the sense that the weakness had been concealed or unnoticed.
- B. It means the weakness disappeared.
- C. It changes the subject.
- D. It makes the sentence longer.

Garden Path

The path threads between old trees before reaching the pond.

5. Why use threads instead of goes?

- A. To suggest a narrow, winding route through the trees.
- B. To explain sewing.
- C. To show the trees are moving.
- D. To prove the path is new.

6. What kind of effect is strongest?

- A. imagery and precision
- B. legal authority
- C. statistical accuracy
- D. humor

Answer key and reasoning

Flood Gate

1. A. Surged communicates both movement and strong intensity.
2. A. Flowed is more neutral and less intense.

Team Debrief

3. A. Exposed suggests revealing something that had not been obvious before.
4. A. Showed communicates visibility but not the same revelation of a hidden weakness.

Garden Path

5. A. Threads creates a precise visual image of a route weaving through obstacles.
6. A. The verb adds a specific visual shape to the movement.

Mistake review

- If you chose a familiar meaning that did not fit the context, label it wrong sense.
- If you chose an option based on one word but ignored the rest of the passage, label it one-clue trap.
- If you understood the basic meaning but missed attitude or effect, label it effect missed.
- Redo the question later without looking at the key.